

Backup Transfer Troubleshooting

Problem 1: docker cp fails on VPS

Sometimes the backup exists inside the container:

```
docker exec govtjobsnow_db ls -lh /tmp/govtjobsnow_backup.backup
```

But this fails:

```
docker cp govtjobsnow_db:/tmp/govtjobsnow_backup.backup /root/  
govtjobsnow_backup.backup
```

Error:

```
Could not find the file in container
```

Solution: Use cat instead of docker cp

Copy file from container to VPS host:

```
docker exec govtjobsnow_db cat /tmp/govtjobsnow_backup.backup > /root/  
govtjobsnow_backup.backup
```

Verify:

```
ls -lh /root/govtjobsnow_backup.backup
```

Problem 2: SCP Download Fails

Normal Method

Run from Windows PowerShell:

```
scp root@72.60.101.23:/root/govtjobsnow_backup.backup D:\Backup
```

Common Mistake

Running the SCP command on the VPS:

```
scp root@72.60.101.23:/root/govtjobsnow_backup.backup D:\Backup
```

Error:

```
ssh: Could not resolve hostname d
```

Reason:

Linux VPS does not understand Windows paths.

Always run SCP from your Windows machine.

Alternative: Use WinSCP

If SCP fails:

1. Open WinSCP
2. Protocol: SFTP
3. Host: VPS IP
4. Username: root
5. Password: VPS Password
6. Navigate to:

```
/root/govtjobsnow_backup.backup
```

1. Drag file to:

```
D:\Backup
```

Problem 3: docker cp into Local Container Appears Successful but File Missing

Example:

```
docker cp D:\Backup\govtjobsnow_backup.backup govtjobsnow_db:/tmp/  
govtjobsnow_backup.backup
```

Docker says:

```
Successfully copied
```

But:

```
docker exec govtjobsnow_db ls -lh /tmp/govtjobsnow_backup.backup
```

returns:

```
No such file or directory
```

Solution

Copy to container root instead:

```
docker cp D:\Backup\govtjobsnow_backup.backup govtjobsnow_db:/govtjobsnow_backup.backup
```

Verify:

```
docker exec govtjobsnow_db ls -lh /govtjobsnow_backup.backup
```

Restore using:

```
docker exec govtjobsnow_db pg_restore -U postgres -d govtjobsnow /govtjobsnow_backup.backup
```

One-Line Backup Workflow (Most Reliable)

VPS

Create backup:

```
docker exec govtjobsnow_db pg_dump -U postgres -Fc govtjobsnow -f /tmp/govtjobsnow_backup.backup
```

Copy to host:

```
docker exec govtjobsnow_db cat /tmp/govtjobsnow_backup.backup > /root/govtjobsnow_backup.backup
```

Windows

Download:

```
scp root@72.60.101.23:/root/govtjobsnow_backup.backup D:\Backup
```

Local Docker

Copy into container:

```
docker cp D:\Backup\govtjobsnow_backup.backup govtjobsnow_db:/govtjobsnow_backup.backup
```

Restore:

```
docker exec govtjobsnow_db pg_restore -U postgres -d govtjobsnow /govtjobsnow_backup.backup
```